

Ginger & Root Storage

Long-term freeze methods: whole knobs + pasta cubes

Ginger — Two Storage Formats

Format	Method	Shelf life	When to use
Whole Knobs (3-month day)	Wash. Do NOT peel. Freeze whole in sealed bag.	3 months	Grate directly from frozen — skin grates off naturally. Semi-frozen is easiest to peel if needed. Buy ~2 kg on 3-month day.
Paste Cubes (monthly refresh)	Pull 2–3 knobs from freezer. Rest 5 min (semi-frozen easiest to peel). Peel. Blend with 2–3 tbsp cold water in Vitamix 60 sec. Portion ~1 tbsp per mini cube cell. Freeze overnight → transfer to labeled bag.	3 months	1 cube = ~1 inch knob equivalent. Drop from frozen into warm pan or recipes.

Label: Ginger — [date] — use by [date +3 months]

Matcha Hack (morning 09:15 — temperature regulator)

Step	Action
1	Boil water
2	Drop 1 frozen ginger cube into cup — cube pulls temp down toward 170°F (76°C) naturally
3	Pour near-boiling water over cube. Let fully melt, stir to incorporate (~30 sec)
4	Confirm temp ≤ 170°F — THEN whisk in matcha powder
5	Rationale: 170°F protects L-theanine + EGCG from heat degradation. Ginger cube = flavor + temperature regulator in one step.



Rested Garlic Cubes — monthly · ~14 cubes · shelf life 3 months frozen

Step	Action	Time
1	Pull ~20 frozen garlic cloves. Thaw 10 min at room temp	10 min
2	Smash and mince finely	—
3	REST 10 MINUTES — allicin formation window. Set a timer. Non-negotiable.	10 min EXACTLY
4	Add 4–5 drops avocado oil to bind	—
5	Portion into mini cube tray (~1 tsp per cell). Freeze overnight.	—

■ **NEVER freeze before the 10-min rest. Ice crystals damage alliinase — thawed whole garlic cannot form allicin after freezing. Rest must happen before the freeze.**

Long-Term Freeze: Herbs, Leaves & Coconut

Ingredient	Blanch?	Method	Shelf life
Cilantro (bunches)	YES — 10 sec	Wash + dry → blanch 10 sec → ice bath 30 sec → dry → flat bag	3 months
Mint (bunches)	YES — 10 sec	Same as cilantro	3 months
Curry leaves	NO	Wash + dry → spread on tray → freeze 1 hr → airtight bag Use frozen directly for tadka — no thawing needed	3 months
Fresh coconut (grated)	NO	Spread on tray → freeze 1 hr (prevents clumping) → bag Measure frozen directly into blender for chutney	3 months



Chilies (whole)	NO	Freeze whole in labeled bags by variety	3–6 months
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■ **Blanching cilantro + mint: 10 seconds only — stops browning (PPO deactivation) without cooking the herb. Longer exposure degrades the chelation compounds.**

